BRAND STORY / EDITION 01 / OCTOBER 2026

THE SEAM

Where intelligence meets the work it was built for.

VAIS

APPLIED INTELLIGENCE SYSTEMS



Kampala, Uganda / vais.co

INSIDE

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This book tells the story of the VAIS identity first, then sets out the rules for using it. Every image in it is part of the system: five generated hero renders, plus vector artwork built to match your final logo.

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A model that works in a demo has done the easy part.

The hard part is a school that loses signal for days. A feature phone with a screen the size of a matchbox. A ministry that needs a briefing it can defend line by line, and a server with 2GB of memory because that is the server there is.

That is the ground VAIS works on. This book describes the identity built to stand on it.

THE HARD PART STARTS HERE



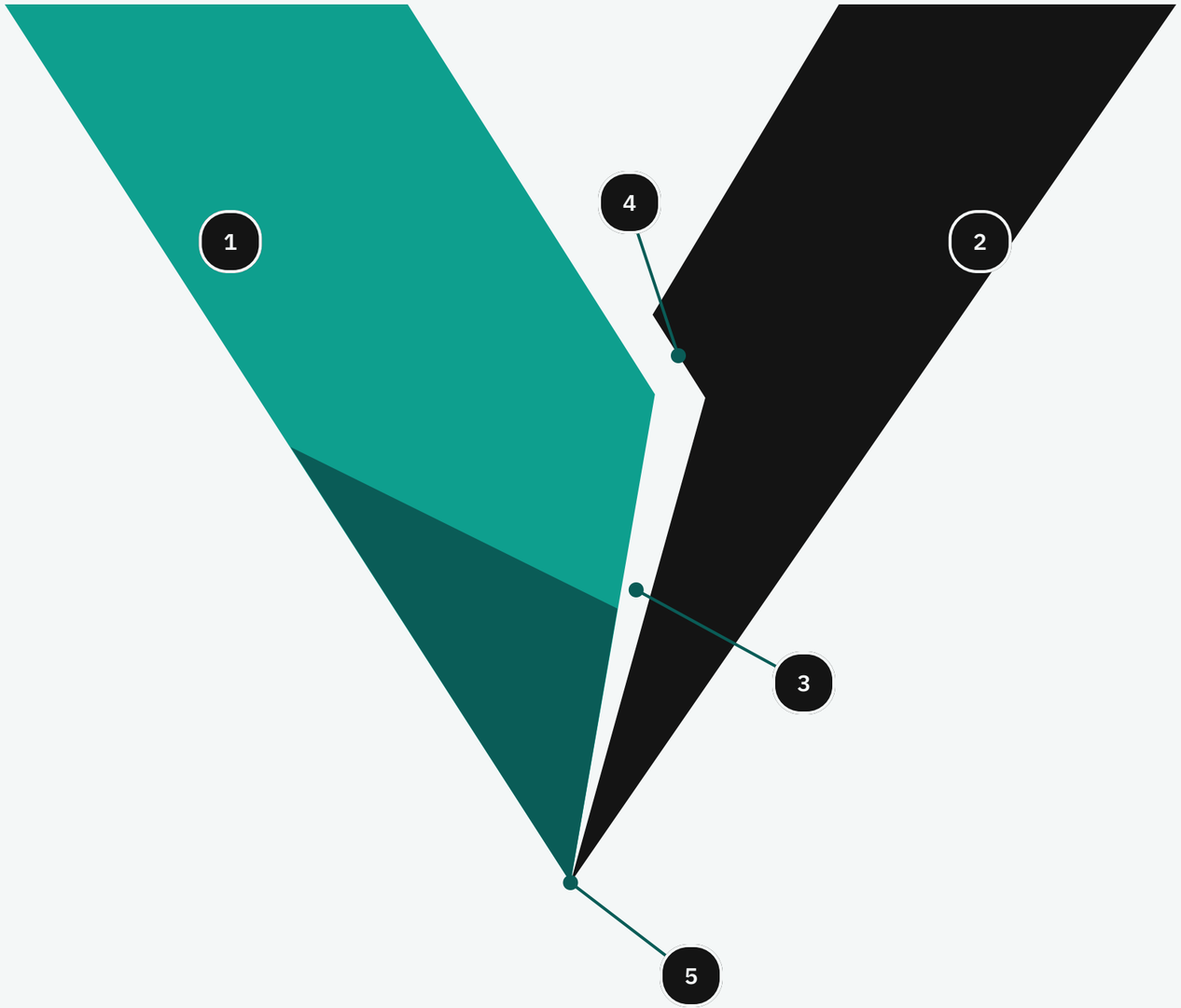
01 / THE IDEA

Two halves. One seam.

The mark is a V split down its length. One half is cut like crystal, the other like obsidian, and between them runs a hairline of light that narrows to a single point.

The tagline already says who is who. In APPLIED **INTELLIGENCE** SYSTEMS, the middle word is the only one set in teal, so the crystal half is intelligence. The black half carries the other two words: the applied, operational, institutional side, where a system has to survive contact with a real place.

The seam is where the two meet. Every choice in this identity exists to keep that moment visible.



01 / ANATOMY

Five parts, five meanings.

1 **Crystal half**

Intelligence. Faceted, luminous, the first thing the eye lands on.

2 **Obsidian half**

Applied and Systems. Dense, polished, reliable. It never glows. It holds.

3 **The seam**

The hairline where the halves meet. In dark mode it carries light. In print it is the paper showing through.

4 **The step**

A small notch on the black half. Every real deployment has an edge it must be built around: a power cut, a bandwidth ceiling, a regulation. The step is that edge, drawn into the mark.

5 **The point**

Both halves converge on one tip. Many inputs, one precise action.

02 / THE POSITION

Three words, three commitments.

APPLIED

Built for the place it will run. Offline first where the network is unreliable. USSD where the handset is basic. A 2GB server where that is the server there is.

INTELLIGENCE

Reasoning that shows its work. Models propose, the person with the authority decides, and the record shows who approved what.

SYSTEMS

Parts that fit together and survive handover. Data bounded by role, an audit trail on every action, documentation an official can follow.

THE BRAND LINE

Intelligence that holds up in the field.

02 / VOICE

A voice that sounds like it was there.

TRAIT	SOUNDS LIKE	NEVER SOUNDS LIKE
EXACT	Says 42,838 schools, not thousands of schools.	~~Revolutionary. Game-changing. Next-generation.~~
CALM	States the constraint first, then the design that meets it.	~~Exclamation marks. Urgency theatre. Hype verbs.~~
ACCOUNTABLE	Names who reviews, who approves and what gets logged.	~~Trust us. Powered by AI. Seamless.~~
LOCAL	Kampala, Makerere, MTN MoMo, NITA-U, Luganda.	~~Emerging markets. The continent. Last-mile solutions.~~

Write the way a good field engineer talks to a permanent secretary: plain verbs, real numbers, no adjectives doing a number's job.



03 / THE MARK

The master lockup.

Dimensional, glossy and deliberately heavy. This is the version for first impressions: website headers, covers, signage, the opening page of anything that carries the name.

It lives on white or on very light surfaces. On dark grounds, or anywhere the bevel would clog, move to the flat or glow editions on the next pages.

03 / EDITIONS

Five editions of one mark.



DIMENSIONAL

Heroes, covers, signage. Raster or 3D rendering only, never scaled below 120 px.

MIN 120 PX / 30 MM



FLAT

The default. Interfaces, documents, product screens, anything that must stay crisp.

MIN 24 PX / 7 MM



GLOW

Dark-mode heroes, splash screens, loaders, event stages. Needs a near-black ground.

MIN 80 PX / 20 MM



MONO

One colour only: stamps, engraving, embossing, fax, single-ink print.

MIN 20 PX / 6 MM



SMALL CUT

Favicons and anything under 32 px. The seam is widened and the facet removed so it survives.

BELOW 32 PX ONLY

Default to **Flat**. Reach for **Dimensional** when the layout has room and depth to spare, **Glow** only on dark, **Mono** when the process allows one ink, and the **Small cut** whenever the V drops under 32 px.

03 / LOCKUPS

Six ways to sign.



Horizontal with tagline. The default signature.



Same lockup reversed for dark grounds.



Stacked. Square and vertical formats, posters.



Stacked, reversed.



Horizontal, no tagline, one colour. Stamps and contracts.



Wordmark only, white on brand teal. Packaging and merch.

03 / SPACE AND SIZE

Room to breathe, and a floor.



Clear space equals **x**, half the height of the V. Nothing enters that zone: no text, no edge of the page, no other logo.

ACTUAL RENDERED SIZES



64 px 48 px 32 px 24 px 16 px

ITEM	SCREEN	PRINT
Emblem, flat	24 px	7 mm
Emblem, small cut	16 px	4 mm
Horizontal, no tagline	120 px	30 mm
Horizontal with tagline	220 px	55 mm
Stacked	90 px	25 mm

03 / MISUSE

Eight ways to break it.



Do not stretch or squash



Do not rotate or tilt



Do not recolour the halves



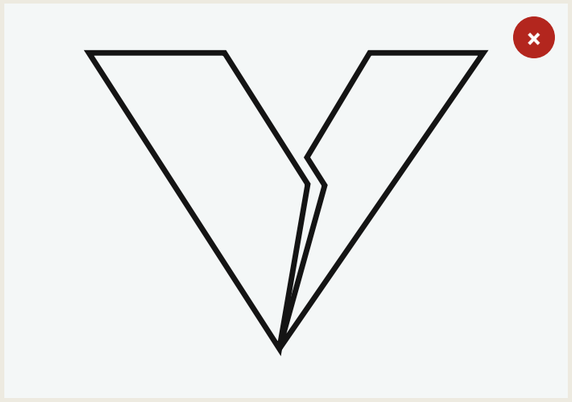
Do not add shadows or bevels to flat marks



Do not place it on brand teal



Do not close the seam



Do not outline it



Do not re-set the wordmark

04 / COLOUR

A teal that earns its place, on ground that stays quiet.

#0E9F8E

Intelligence Teal

RGB 14, 159, 142
CMYK 91 0 11 38

Primary. The crystal half, key actions, accents.

#141414

Obsidian

RGB 20, 20, 20
CMYK 0 0 0 92

The black half, headlines, text on light.

#07090A

Void

RGB 7, 9, 10
CMYK 30 10 0 96

Dark grounds, the Signal register.

#F4F7F7

Mist

RGB 244, 247, 247
CMYK 1 0 0 3

Cool white. Screens, UI, the reversed half.

#EDEAE0

Registry Paper

RGB 237, 234, 224
CMYK 0 1 5 7

Warm paper. Documents, the Record register.

#0A5C57

Deep Teal

RGB 10, 92, 87
CMYK 89 0 5 64

The facet. Small text on light, depth.

#19E6D0

Glow Teal

RGB 25, 230, 208
CMYK 89 0 10 10

Dark mode only. Seam light, highlights.

#5A6366

Slate

RGB 90, 99, 102
CMYK 12 3 0 60

Secondary text and captions.

#D99A2B

Signal Amber

RGB 217, 154, 43
CMYK 0 29 80 15

Status only: in development, pending.

#9C4A24

Laterite

RGB 156, 74, 36
CMYK 0 53 77 39

Heritage accent. Sparingly, for place.



Void / Obsidian 40% | Mist / Paper 34% | Teal 18% | Glow 5% | Status 3%

Mist on Void
18.5 : 1 AAA

Glow on Void
12.6 : 1 AAA

Teal on Void
6.1 : 1 AA

Deep Teal on Mist
7.3 : 1 AAA

Teal on Mist
3.1 : 1 Large text only

CMYK values are conversions for reference. Proof on the actual stock before any print run.

04 / TYPE

Three typefaces, three jobs.

VAIS

ABCDEFGHIJKLM
NOPQRSTUVWXYZ 0123456789

Syncopate Bold

The wordmark voice. Capitals only, six words at most, tracked open (+0.05 to +0.3 em). Titles, labels, the tagline.

Aa

Light, Regular, Medium, SemiBold
Intelligence that holds up

IBM Plex Sans

The working voice. Light (300) for large headlines, Regular (400) for text, Medium and SemiBold (500, 600) for subheads and emphasis.

Aa

REF 01 / 0.3476 N 32.5825 E
DEPLOYED IN DEVELOPMENT

IBM Plex Mono

The record voice. References, coordinates, status tags, captions. Set in capitals with +0.14 to +0.2 em tracking at small sizes.

HIERARCHY IN PRACTICE

EYEBROW / PLEX MONO 500 / 14 / +0.2EM

Headline in Plex Sans Light

Body in Plex Sans Regular, 19 to 21 px on screen, 1.5 line height, never below 11 pt in print.

05 / TWO REGISTERS

One mark, two temperatures.

SIGNAL REGISTER

Intelligence that holds up in the field.



REVIEW THE PORTFOLIO

CONTACT VAIS

Signal is the first impression: dark, luminous, one idea per screen. Websites, decks, covers, social, event screens.

RECORD REGISTER

Register of operations

REF	SYSTEM	DOMAIN	STATUS
01	APEX NEXUS	Civic and Government	IN DEVELOPMENT
02	UGEMS	Civic and Government	DEPLOYED
03	MUBS EC	Education and Institutions	DEPLOYED

Hairline rules, mono references, status as a tag. It reads like a document of record because it is one.

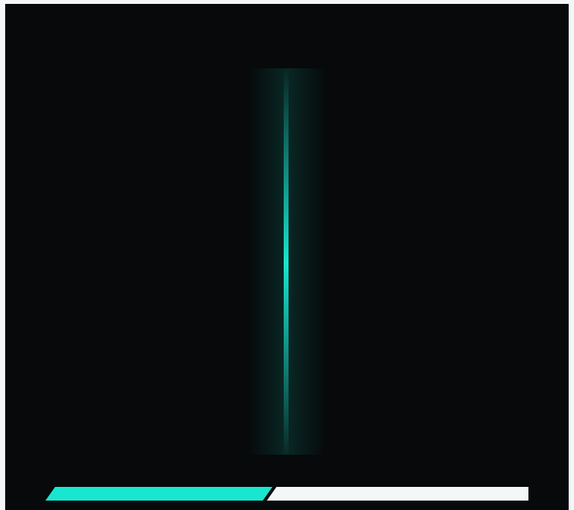
Record is what gets filed: proposals, reports, contracts, ledgers. It also fits the ledger-style direction drafted for the website, with teal in place of the laterite accent.

05 / THE SEAM AS MOTIF

Four devices that carry the idea.



The slash rule: teal, a hairline, obsidian.



The seam line: a single hairline of light.



The lattice: marks at 7 percent, a few lit.



The shard: the V cropped hard at scale.

Use one device per layout, two at the most. They do the job decoration usually does, and each one points back to the mark: a cut, a gap, a line of light.

05 / TERRITORY

One mark, nine territories.

01
CIVIC AND GOVERNMENT

APEX NEXUS / UGEMS / UGADON / IPSAS / GAP / GOVSEF

02
SECURITY AND INTELLIGENCE

GAP / GOVSEF / SENTECT / YERACLE

03
HEALTH

NK UZIMA

04
AGRICULTURE

CROP CIRCLES

05
EDUCATION AND INSTITUTIONS

MUBS EC

06
FINTECH AND PAYMENTS

YOKOSHING

07
AUTOMOTIVE AND IOT

VERIPATH

08
SUPPLY CHAIN

KREESP

09
PLATFORM

VAIS Voice AI

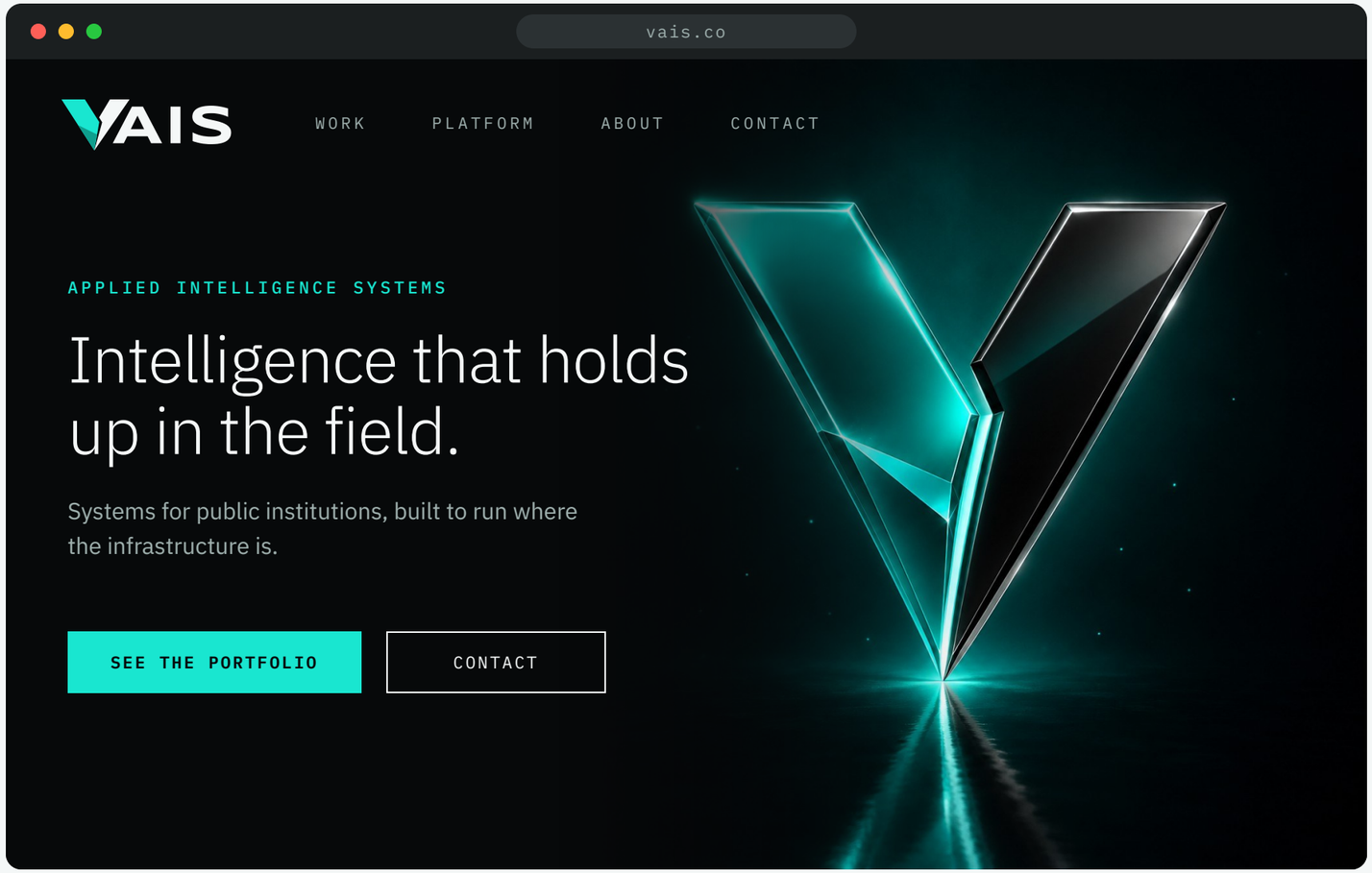
APEX NEXUS

A VAIS system

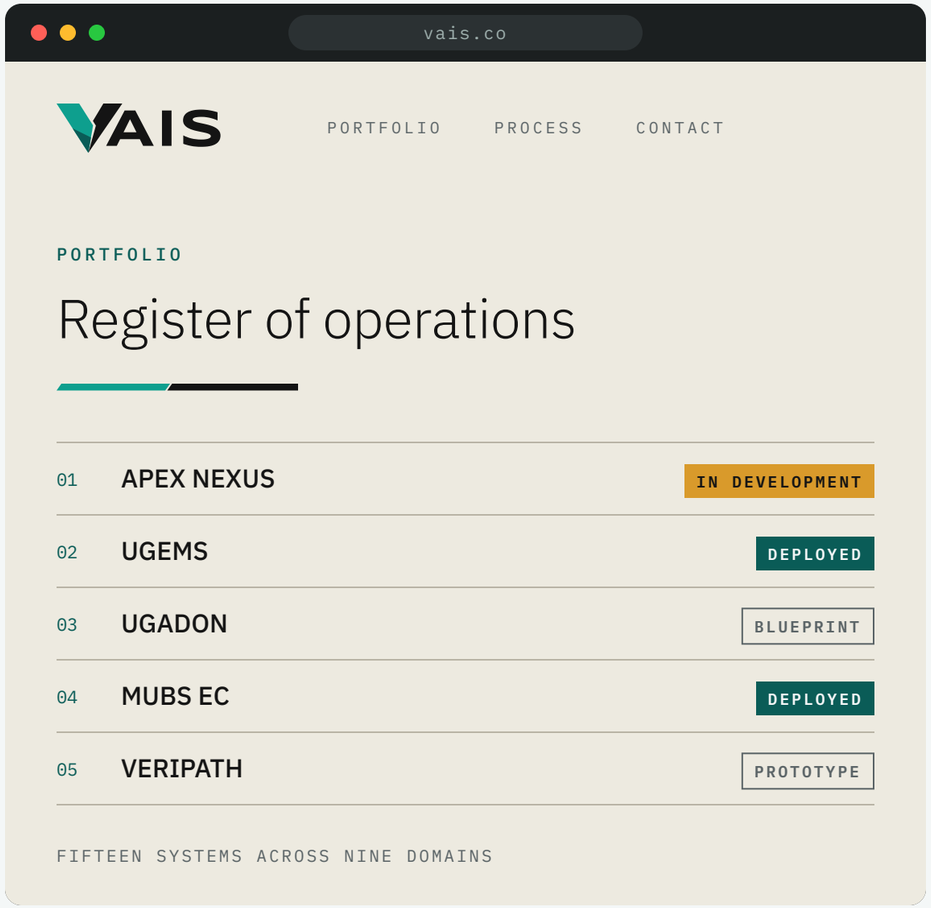
VAIS stays the master brand. Each product keeps its own name in Syncopate and signs off with the V and the line above.

06 / ON THE WEB

The same brand, in both registers.



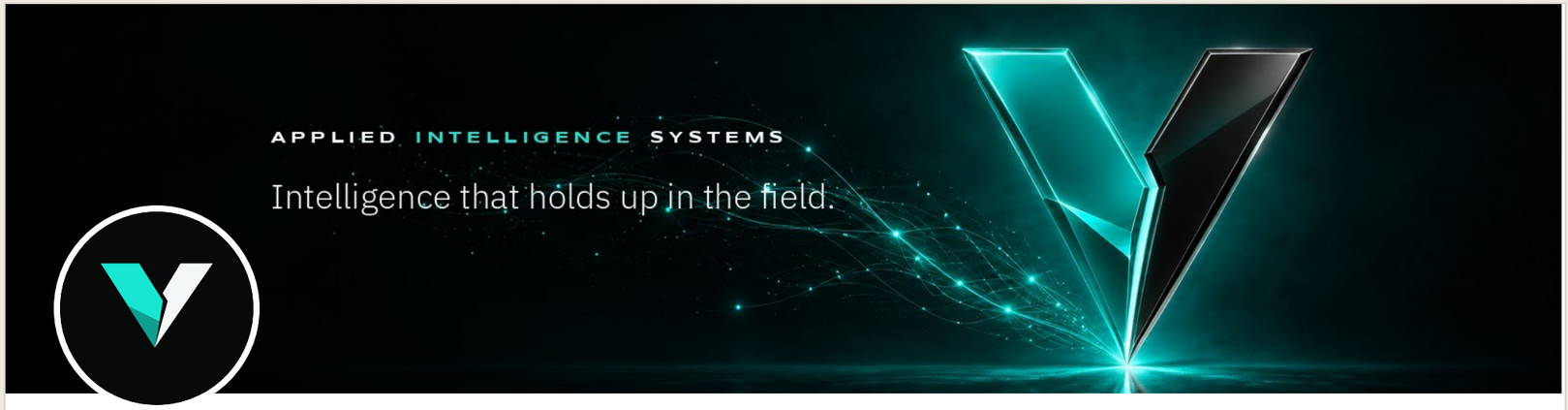
Signal. The home page and campaign pages: dark ground, one headline, the hero render at full strength.



Record. Portfolio, process and documentation pages: paper, hairlines, tagged status.

06 / SOCIAL

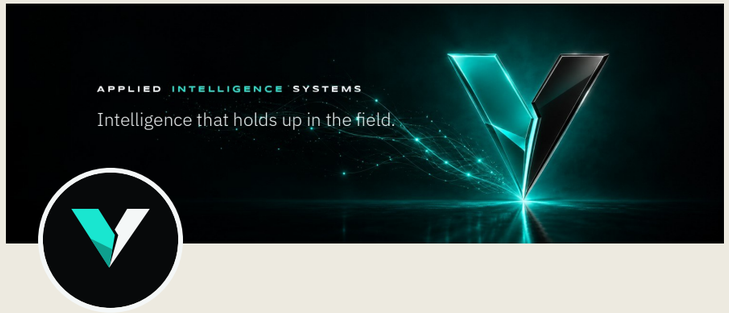
Profiles, headers and posts.



VAIS | Applied Intelligence Systems

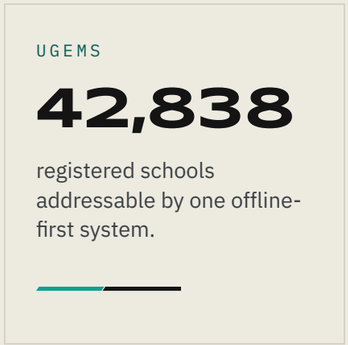
Intelligence that holds up in the field. Kampala, Uganda.

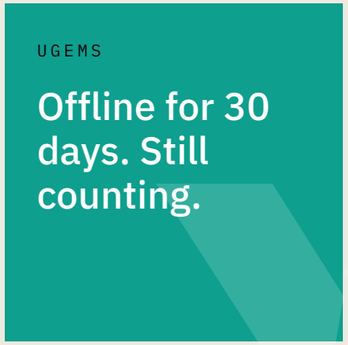
LinkedIn, 1584 x 396. The avatar covers the bottom-left, so the headline sits clear of it.



X header, 1500 x 500. Same artwork, wider crop.







THREE POST TILES

Statement (Void): one line, the slash, the wordmark.
Figure (Paper): a real number in Syncopate, one sentence of context.
Signal (Teal): a short claim, the V as a faint watermark.

Every figure is a real one from the portfolio. If the number is not on record, the tile does not run.

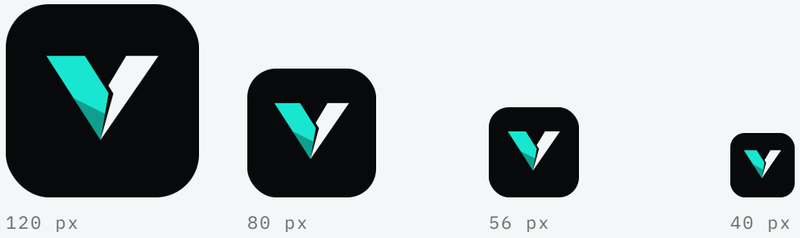
06 / APP ICON AND AVATARS

Small, and still the V.



Dark and light app icons. The V fills 58 percent of the tile, so circle and rounded masks never touch its points.

Use the flat V on a light tile and the reversed V on a Void tile. Never place the Dimensional edition inside an icon.





AVATARS, DARK AND LIGHT



FAVICON 32 / 16, ACTUAL SIZE



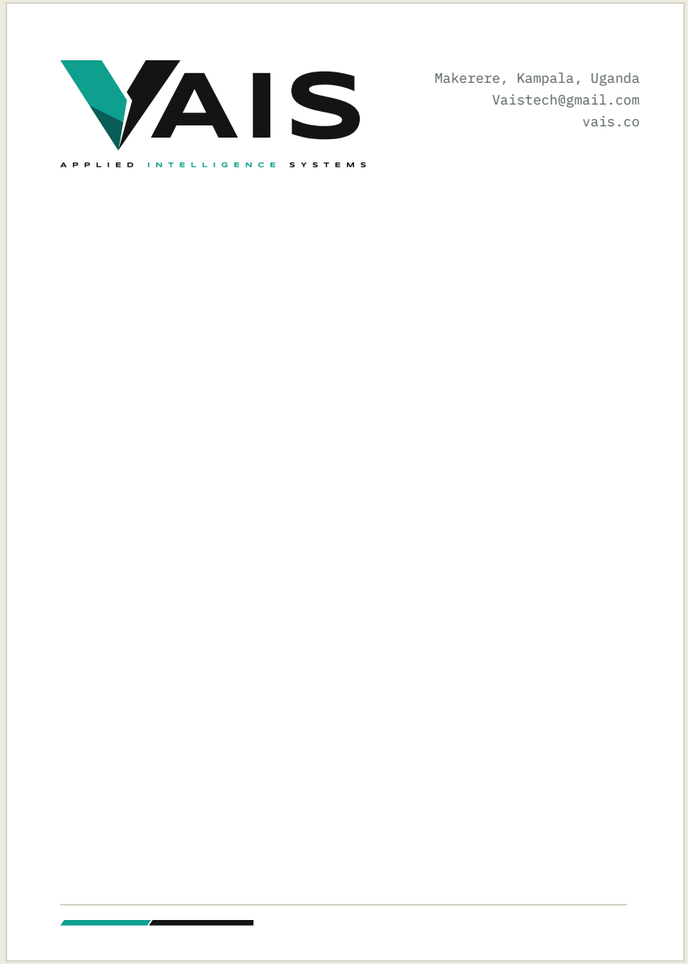


06 / THE V AS AN OBJECT

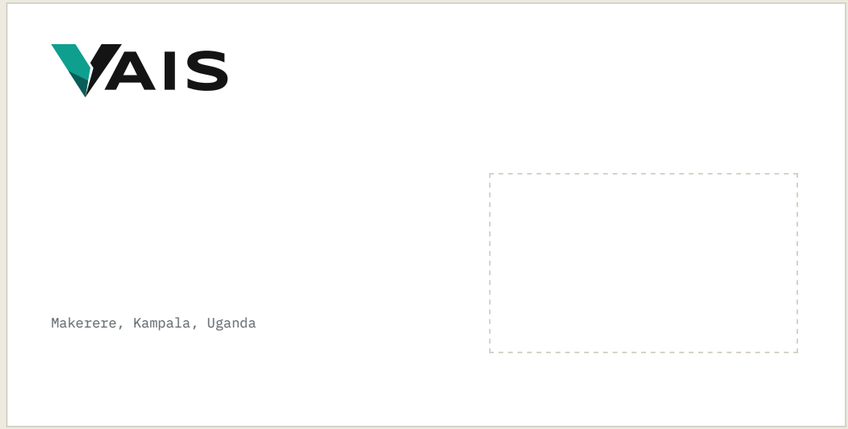
Cut into metal, lit from the seam.

Engraved into anodised aluminium, with a glass inlay on the crystal half and a polished chamfer on the obsidian half. The same logic carries to a reception plaque, a hardware badge, an access card, or a stamped seal on an official document.

The Record register, printed.



Letterhead, A4



DL envelope



Compliment slip, DL

Letterhead and envelope use the light lockup with its tagline on white stock. The compliment slip takes the dark lockup on a Void ground, with the slash as the only ornament.

Print the V in two spot inks where the budget allows: Intelligence Teal and Obsidian. On one-colour jobs, use the Mono edition.

Keep body copy in IBM Plex Sans at 10 to 11 pt, references in Plex Mono.

07 / MOTION

The halves close, then the seam lights.



1 / 0 to 240 ms

The seam appears



2 / 240 to 420 ms

Halves approach



3 / to 660 ms

Halves close



4 / 660 to 780 ms

Seam flares



5 / 780 to 1080 ms

Line settles

TOTAL	1.08 s, once, on entry
HALVES	420 ms, cubic-bezier(.2, .8, .2, 1)
SEAM FLARE	120 ms, then holds at 60 percent
REDUCED MOTION	Show the final frame, instantly
NEVER	Loop faster than every 6 s, spin, bounce or wobble

Motion repeats the brand idea once: two parts come together and the join lights up. It is a reveal, not a performance, and it finishes before anyone has to wait for it.

The seam is where it works.



VAIS

APPLIED INTELLIGENCE SYSTEMS

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The asset pack that goes with this book holds the vector lockups, transparent PNGs, app icons, favicons and the LinkedIn and X banners.